THE DOCTRINES OF GRACE

THE ATONEMENT

Irby Wallace, III
irbywallace3@gmail.com
ponderingthefaith.com

WHY DID JESUS COME TO DIE?

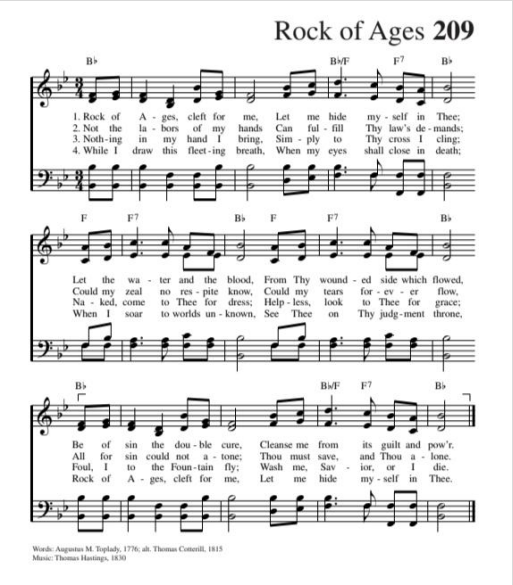
“

Jesus paid it all,
All to Him I owe;
Sin had left a crimson stain,
He washed it white as snow.

”

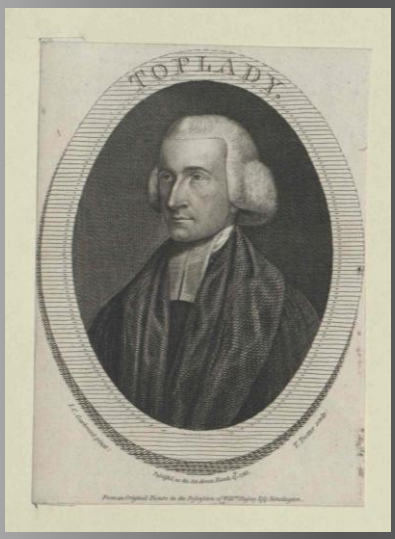
Elvina Mable Hall, “Jesus Paid It All,” 1865.

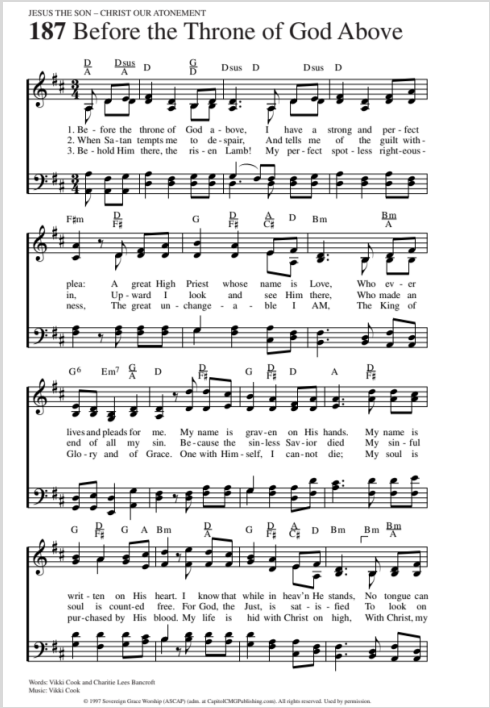
“



Augustus M. Toplady, “Rock of Ages,” 1776.

”





JESUS THE SON – CHRIST OUR ATONEMENT

187 Before the Throne of God Above

1. Be - fore the throne of God a - bove, I have a strong and per - fect plea: A great High Priest whose name is Love, Who ev - er lives and pleads for me. My name is grav - en on His hands. My name is writ - ten on His heart. I know that while in heav'n He stands, No tongue can
2. When Sa - tan tempts me to de - spair, And tells me of the guilt with - in, Up - ward I look and see Him there, Who made an end of all my sin. Be - cause the sin - less Sav - ior died My sin - ful soul is count - ed free. For God, the Just, is sat - is - fied To look on
3. Be - hold Him there, the ris - en Lamb! My per - fect spot - less right - eous - ness, The great un - change - a - ble I AM, The King of Glo - ry and of Grace. One with Him - self, I can - not die; My soul is pur - chased by His blood. My life is hid with Christ on high, With Christ, my

Words: Vikki Cook and Charitie Lees Bancroft
Music: Vikki Cook

© 1997 Sovereign Grace Worship (ASCAP) (adm. at CapitolCMGPublishing.com). All rights reserved. Used by permission.

Charitie Lees Bancroft, "Before the Throne of God Above," 1863.

Definition

- *Atonement*
  - כִּפֶּר (kaphar) – cover over, pacify, make propitiation (BDB Hebrew Lexicon)
- First used in Genesis 6:14, "Make yourself an ark of gopher wood. Make rooms in the ark, and cover it inside and out with pitch." (ESV)

Leviticus 17:10–16 (ESV)
10 "If any one of the house of Israel or of the strangers who sojourn among them eats any blood, I will set my face against that person who eats blood and will cut him off from among his people. 11 For the life of the flesh is in the blood, and I have given it for you on the altar to make atonement for your souls, for it is the blood that makes atonement by the life. 12 Therefore I have said to the people of Israel, No person among you shall eat blood, neither shall any stranger who sojourns among you eat blood.
13 "Any one also of the people of Israel, or of the strangers who sojourn among them, who takes in hunting any beast or bird that may be eaten shall pour out its blood and cover it with earth. 14 For the life of every creature is its blood: its blood is its life. Therefore I have said to the people of Israel, You shall not eat the blood of any creature, for the life of every creature is its blood. Whoever eats it shall be cut off. 15 And every person who eats what dies of itself or what is torn by beasts, whether he is a native or a sojourner, shall wash his clothes and bathe himself in water and be unclean until the evening; then he shall be clean. 16 But if he does not wash them or bathe his flesh, he shall bear his iniquity."

Atonement

- According to Leviticus 17, what is required for atonement?
  - Death and blood

“

Genesis 32:20–21 (ESV)
*20 and you shall say, ‘Moreover, your servant Jacob is behind us.’ ” For he thought, “I may **appease** him with the present that goes ahead of me, and afterward I shall see his face. Perhaps he will accept me.” 21 So the present passed on ahead of him, and he himself stayed that night in the camp.*

”

“

Exodus 32:30 (ESV)
*30 The next day Moses said to the people, “You have sinned a great sin. And now I will go up to the LORD; perhaps I can make **atonement** for your sin.”*

”

“

Leviticus 4:20–21 (ESV)
20 Thus shall he do with the bull. As he did with the bull of the sin offering, so shall he do with this. And the priest shall make ***atonement*** *for them, and they shall be forgiven. 21 And he shall carry the bull outside the camp and burn it up as he burned the first bull; it is the sin offering for the assembly.*

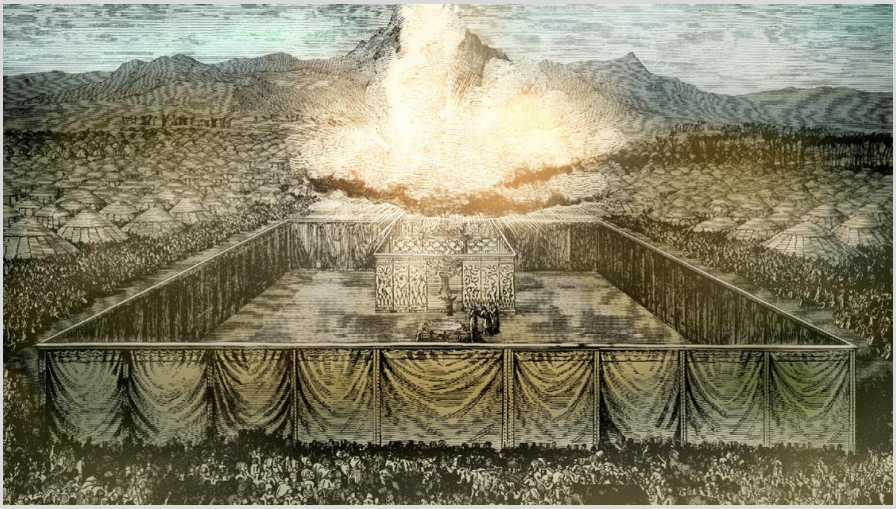
”

“

Psalm 78:37–40 (ESV)
37 Their heart was not steadfast toward him; they were not faithful to his covenant.
38 Yet he, being compassionate,
atoned for their iniquity
and did not destroy them;
he restrained his anger often
and did not stir up all his wrath.
39 He remembered that they were but flesh,
a wind that passes and comes not again.
40 How often they rebelled against him in the wilderness and grieved him in the desert!

”

Psalm 79



Atonement in the OT

- From the verses above, what do we gather that atonement is?
- Why is atonement necessary?

Atonement in the NT

- The word atonement does not appear in the New Testament
- Though the word is never used, the elements of Christ's atonement are related to us in many ways

Atonement in the NT

- Was Jesus' atonement forced on Him?

“

John 10:17-18 (ESV)
17 For this reason the Father loves me, because I lay down my life that I may take it up again. 18 No one takes it from me, but I lay it down of my own accord. I have authority to lay it down, and I have authority to take it up again. This charge I have received from my Father.

”

Jesus as a Ransom

Definition

- *Ransom* – price of release

“

Hosea 13:14 (ESV)

14 I shall ransom them from the power of Sheol;
I shall redeem them from Death.
O Death, where are your plagues?
O Sheol, where is your sting?
Compassion is hidden from my eyes.

”

“

Matthew 20:22–28 (ESV)
22 Jesus answered, “You do not know what you are asking. Are you able to drink the cup that I am to drink?” They said to him, “We are able.” 23 He said to them, “You will drink my cup, but to sit at my right hand and at my left is not mine to grant, but it is for those for whom it has been prepared by my Father.” 24 And when the ten heard it, they were indignant at the two brothers. 25 But Jesus called them to him and said, “You know that the rulers of the Gentiles lord it over them, and their great ones exercise authority over them. 26 It shall not be so among you. But whoever would be great among you must be your servant, 27 and whoever would be first among you must be your slave, 28 even as the Son of Man came not to be served but to serve, and to give his life as a ***ransom*** *for many.”*

”

see also Mark 10:45

“

1 Timothy 2:5–7 (ESV)
5 For there is one God, and there is one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus, 6 who gave himself as a ***ransom*** *for all, which is the testimony given at the proper time. 7 For this I was appointed a preacher and an apostle (I am telling the truth, I am not lying), a teacher of the Gentiles in faith and truth.*

”

“

1 Peter 1:17–21 (ESV)
*17 And if you call on him as Father who judges impartially according to each one’s deeds, conduct yourselves with fear throughout the time of your exile, 18 knowing that you were **ransomed** from the futile ways inherited from your forefathers, not with perishable things such as silver or gold, 19 but with the precious blood of Christ, like that of a lamb without blemish or spot. 20 He was foreknown before the foundation of the world but was made manifest in the last times for the sake of you 21 who through him are believers in God, who raised him from the dead and gave him glory, so that your faith and hope are in God.*

”

“

Revelation 5:9–10 (ESV)
9 And they sang a new song, saying,
“Worthy are you to take the scroll
and to open its seals,
*for you were slain, and by your blood you **ransomed** people for God*
from every tribe and language and people and nation,
10 and you have made them a kingdom and priests to our God,
and they shall reign on the earth.”

”

Jesus as Redeemer

Definition

- *Redeemer* – to liberate from an oppressive situation a by paying a ransom, to set free, to rescue

“

Galatians 3:13–14 (ESV)
13 Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law by becoming a curse for us—
for it is written, “Cursed is everyone who is hanged on a tree”— 14 so that in
Christ Jesus the blessing of Abraham might come to the Gentiles, so that we
might receive the promised Spirit through faith.

”

“

Galatians 4:4–7 (ESV)
4 But when the fullness of time had come, God sent forth his Son, born of
woman, born under the law, 5 to redeem those who were under the law, so that
we might receive adoption as sons. 6 And because you are sons, God has sent
the Spirit of his Son into our hearts, crying, “Abba! Father!” 7 So you are no
longer a slave, but a son, and if a son, then an heir through God.

”

“

Titus 2:11–14 (ESV)
11 For the grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation for all people,
12 training us to renounce ungodliness and worldly passions, and to live self-controlled, upright, and godly lives in the present age, 13 waiting for our blessed hope, the appearing of the glory of our great God and Savior Jesus Christ, 14 who gave himself for us to redeem us from all lawlessness and to purify for himself a people for his own possession who are zealous for good works.

”

“

Hebrews 9:15 (ESV)
15 Therefore he is the mediator of a new covenant, so that those who are called may receive the promised eternal inheritance, since a death has occurred that redeems them from the transgressions committed under the first covenant.

”

Jesus as a Propitiation

Definition

- *Propitiation* – instrument for appeasing, to cause to be favorably inclined or disposed

“

Romans 3:21–26 (ESV)
21 But now the righteousness of God has been manifested apart from the law, although the Law and the Prophets bear witness to it— 22 the righteousness of God through faith in Jesus Christ for all who believe. For there is no distinction: 23 for all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God, 24 and are justified by his grace as a gift, through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus, 25 whom God put forward as a ***propitiation*** *by his blood, to be received by faith. This was to show God's righteousness, because in his divine forbearance he had passed over former sins. 26 It was to show his righteousness at the present time, so that he might be just and the justifier of the one who has faith in Jesus.*

”

“

Hebrews 2:14–3:1 (ESV)
14 Since therefore the children share in flesh and blood, he himself likewise partook of the same things, that through death he might destroy the one who has the power of death, that is, the devil, 15 and deliver all those who through fear of death were subject to lifelong slavery. 16 For surely it is not angels that he helps, but he helps the offspring of Abraham. 17 Therefore he had to be made like his brothers in every respect, so that he might become a merciful and faithful high priest in the service of God, to make ***propitiation*** *for the sins of the people. 18 For because he himself has suffered when tempted, he is able to help those who are being tempted.*

”

“

Hebrews 10:10-14

”

“

1 John 2:1–2 (ESV)
2 *My little children, I am writing these things to you so that you may not sin. But if anyone does sin, we have an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous.* **2** *He is the* ***propitiation*** *for our sins, and not for ours only but also for the sins of the whole world.*

”

“

1 John 4:9–10 (ESV)
9 In this the love of God was made manifest among us, that God sent his only Son into the world, so that we might live through him. 10 In this is love, not that we have loved God but that he loved us and sent his Son to be the ***propitiation*** *for our sins.*

”

Jesus as Reconciliation

Definition

- *Reconciliation* – to exchange hostility for a friendly relationship

“

Romans 5:10–11 (ESV)
10 For if while we were enemies we were reconciled to God by the death of his Son, much more, now that we are reconciled, shall we be saved by his life.
11 More than that, we also rejoice in God through our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom we have now received reconciliation.

”

“

2 Corinthians 5:18–20 (ESV)
18 All this is from God, who through Christ reconciled us to himself and gave us the ministry of reconciliation; 19 that is, in Christ God was reconciling the world to himself, not counting their trespasses against them, and entrusting to us the message of reconciliation. 20 Therefore, we are ambassadors for Christ, God making his appeal through us. We implore you on behalf of Christ, be reconciled to God.

”

“

Ephesians 2:13–16 (ESV)
13 But now in Christ Jesus you who once were far off have been brought near by the blood of Christ. 14 For he himself is our peace, who has made us both one and has broken down in his flesh the dividing wall of hostility 15 by abolishing the law of commandments expressed in ordinances, that he might create in himself one new man in place of the two, so making peace, 16 and might reconcile us both to God in one body through the cross, thereby killing the hostility.

”

“

Colossians 1:19–23 (ESV)
19 For in him all the fullness of God was pleased to dwell, 20 and through him
to reconcile to himself all things, whether on earth or in heaven, making peace
by the blood of his cross.
21 And you, who once were alienated and hostile in mind, doing evil deeds,
22 he has now reconciled in his body of flesh by his death, in order to present
you holy and blameless and above reproach before him, 23 if indeed you
continue in the faith, stable and steadfast, not shifting from the hope of the
gospel that you heard, which has been proclaimed in all creation under
heaven, and of which I, Paul, became a minister.

”

Jesus as Our Substitute

“

2 Corinthians 5:21 (ESV)
21 For our sake he made him to be sin who knew no sin, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God.

”

“

1 Peter 3:18 (ESV)
18 For Christ also suffered once for sins, the righteous for the unrighteous, that he might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh but made alive in the spirit,

”

“

Galatians 3:10–14 (ESV)
10 For all who rely on works of the law are under a curse; for it is written,
“Cursed be everyone who does not abide by all things written in the Book of
the Law, and do them.” 11 Now it is evident that no one is justified before God
by the law, for “The righteous shall live by faith.” 12 But the law is not of
faith, rather “The one who does them shall live by them.” 13 Christ redeemed
us from the curse of the law by becoming a curse for us—for it is written,
“Cursed is everyone who is hanged on a tree”— 14 so that in Christ Jesus the
blessing of Abraham might come to the Gentiles, so that we might receive the
promised Spirit through faith.

”

Christ as Victor

“

John 12:30–32 (ESV)
30 Jesus answered, “This voice has come for your sake, not mine. 31 Now is the judgment of this world; now will the ruler of this world be cast out. 32 And I, when I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all people to myself.”

”

“

Romans 6:8–11 (ESV)
8 Now if we have died with Christ, we believe that we will also live with him. 9 We know that Christ, being raised from the dead, will never die again; death no longer has dominion over him. 10 For the death he died he died to sin, once for all, but the life he lives he lives to God. 11 So you also must consider yourselves dead to sin and alive to God in Christ Jesus.

”

“

Ephesians 2:1–7 (ESV)
2 *And you were dead in the trespasses and sins* [2] *in which you once walked, following the course of this world, following the prince of the power of the air, the spirit that is now at work in the sons of disobedience—* [3] *among whom we all once lived in the passions of our flesh, carrying out the desires of the flesh and the mind, and were by nature children of wrath, like the rest of mankind.* [4] *But God, being rich in mercy, because of the great love with which he loved us,* [5] *even when we were dead in our trespasses, made us alive together with Christ—by grace you have been saved—* [6] *and raised us up with him and seated us with him in the heavenly places in Christ Jesus,* [7] *so that in the coming ages he might show the immeasurable riches of his grace in kindness toward us in Christ Jesus.*

”

“

Colossians 2:12–15 (ESV)
[12] *having been buried with him in baptism, in which you were also raised with him through faith in the powerful working of God, who raised him from the dead.* [13] *And you, who were dead in your trespasses and the uncircumcision of your flesh, God made alive together with him, having forgiven us all our trespasses,* [14] *by canceling the record of debt that stood against us with its legal demands. This he set aside, nailing it to the cross.* [15] *He disarmed the rulers and authorities and put them to open shame, by triumphing over them in him.*

”

“

Hebrews 2:14–15 (ESV)
14 Since therefore the children share in flesh and blood, he himself likewise partook of the same things, that through death he might destroy the one who has the power of death, that is, the devil, 15 and deliver all those who through fear of death were subject to lifelong slavery.

”

“

1 John 3:8 (ESV)
8 Whoever makes a practice of sinning is of the devil, for the devil has been sinning from the beginning. The reason the Son of God appeared was to destroy the works of the devil.

”

“

Revelation 11:15 (ESV)
15 Then the seventh angel blew his trumpet, and there were loud voices in heaven, saying, “The kingdom of the world has become the kingdom of our Lord and of his Christ, and he shall reign forever and ever.”

”